Interesting Reads: essay links

Built from *FULL IR SERIES* (Interesting reads #1 to #51). Every link was opened and checked in October 2026. Each entry shows one link to use: the original where it is free, the official link for paid posts (plus a free archived copy where one exists), or an archived copy where the original is gone.

At a glance

- **283** unique items (252 essays/articles, 18 videos, 12 X posts, 1 book) across 50 issues; 285 listings in total.
- **OK** original link works and is free to read: **267**
- **PAID** official link included; needs a subscription: **12** (6 also have a free archived copy)
- **BROKEN** original is dead, removed or unavailable: **4** (3 replaced with an archived copy or re-upload)
- **BOT-BLOCKED** could not be verified: **0** (9 links blocked automated checks; all were re-checked with a real browser or by the site's known paywall and resolved)
- No working link at all: **1**
- Cover images downloaded: **270** (of which 1 is only a generic site image); no image available: **13** (paulgraham.com essays ×9, hermiene.net, NK.exe, Scott H Young, an X post)

Paid posts (official link)

- **What Makes Someone Cool? A New Study Offers Clues** (The New York Times, #1): free archived copy also listed
- **An AI glossary** (Lenny's Newsletter, #1): no free copy
- **Indian Biscuits: 1947-2022–The Story of the Nation State in Five Biscuits** (Vittles, #3): free archived copy also listed
- **What If I'm Not Technical Enough for AI?** (Nate’s Substack, #10): no free copy
- **The Bliss of a Quieter Ego** (The Atlantic, #11): free archived copy also listed
- **You're overspending because you lack values** (sherryning.com, #12): free archived copy also listed
- **You are no longer the smartest type of thing on Earth** (Noahpinion, #26): no free copy
- **White Collar Goes Blue** (Working Theorys, #30): free archived copy also listed
- **No One Will Remember Your Name** (The Write Path, #34): free archived copy also listed
- **Riding the Leopard** (Not Boring, #41): no free copy
- **Why Nature Allowed a Trillionaire to Exist** (The Write Path, #44): no free copy
- **Extinction is a continuum** (Vittles, #50): no free copy

No working link

- **The Inside of the Outside is the Inside** (NK.exe, #8): Post removed by its author; no archived copy or republication found.

Notes on the source

- There is no issue #31 in the PDF (the numbering jumps from #30 to #32), and the page headed "Interesting Apps" (apps, no links) is not included.
- Listed in more than one issue (kept once, shown under each issue): Using AI Right Now: A Quick Guide: Which AIs to use, and how to use them (#5 and #6); The untold story of Where is My Train's 100M users (#7 and #21).
- Wayback Machine links are archived copies that were checked to contain the full text. Videos and X posts from the newsletter are included and marked as such.

Interesting reads #1

Different Kinds of Smart OK

Morgan Housel · Collaborative Fund

Link: collabfund.com/blog/different-kinds-of-smart/

What Makes Someone Cool? A New Study Offers Clues PAID

Christina Caron · The New York Times

Official link (paid): nytimes.com/2025/06/30/well/mind/cool-people-traits-study.html

Free archived copy: web.archive.org (archived 2025-07-18): nytimes.com/2025/06/30/well/mind/cool-people-traits-study.h…

The official link needs a subscription; the free archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

An AI glossary PAID

Lenny Rachitsky · Lenny's Newsletter

Official link (paid): lennysnewsletter.com/p/an-ai-glossary

The official link needs a subscription; no free copy exists.

Poor Charlie's Almanack OK

Charlie Munger · Book

Link: archive.org/details/poor-charlies-almanack-the-wit-and-wisdom-of-charles-t.-m…

Also free to read from the publisher, Stripe Press: stripe.press/poor-charlies-almanack/book

Interesting reads #2

AI 2027 Report OK

Daniel Kokotajlo, Scott Alexander, Thomas Larsen, Eli Lifland, Romeo Dean · ai-2027.com

Link: ai-2027.com/

Mental Models: The Best Way to Make Intelligent Decisions (~100 Models Explained) OK

Shane Parrish · Farnam Street

Link: fs.blog/mental-models/

Cities and Ambition OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/cities.html

Design: The Good, The Bad And The Ugly OK

Tao · China Playbook

Link: chinaplaybook.substack.com/p/33-design-the-good-the-bad-and-the

Media and Machines OK

Anu Atluru · Working Theorys

Link: workingtheorys.com/p/the-media-machine-singularity

Interesting reads #3

How Bangalore Came To Be India's Tech Capital OK

Aaryaman Vir · Tigerfeathers

Link: tigerfeathers.in/p/how-bangalore-came-to-be-indias-tech

There’s a place for everyone OK

Adam Mastroianni · Experimental History

Link: experimental-history.com/p/theres-a-place-for-everyone

Indian Biscuits: 1947-2022–The Story of the Nation State in Five Biscuits PAID

Sharanya Deepak · Vittles

Official link (paid): vittlesmagazine.com/p/indian-biscuits-1947-2022

Free archived copy: web.archive.org (archived 2023-12-11): vittlesmagazine.com/p/indian-biscuits-1947-2022

The official link needs a subscription; the free archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

Platonically irrational: How much did Plato know about behavioural economics and cognitive biases? OK

Nick Romeo · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/what-plato-knew-about-behavioural-economics-a-lot

High Agency In 30 Minutes OK

George Mack · High Agency

Link: highagency.com/

Interesting reads #4

Happy Ambition OK

Ben Casnocha · casnocha.com

Link: casnocha.com/happy-ambition-status-cocaine

The Importance of Being Useful OK

Julio Froment · Picking Nuggets

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-168211835

Why your product idea sounds too complicated OK

Andrew Chen · andrewchen.substack.com

Link: andrewchen.substack.com/p/why-your-product-idea-sounds-too

Means and Meaning: We have the technology. Cool, now what? OK

Packy McCormick · Not Boring

Link: notboring.co/p/means-and-meaning

Whatever You Wish OK

Isaac Asimov · hermiene.net

Link: hermiene.net/essays-trans/whatever_you_wish.html

Interesting reads #5

The Unseen OK

Allison J Pugh · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/our-crisis-is-not-loneliness-but-human-beings-becoming-invisib…

You can learn anything in 2 weeks OK

Dan Koe · Future/Proof

Link: letters.thedankoe.com/p/you-can-learn-anything-in-2-weeks

How to write usefully OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/useful.html

In plain sight OK

Lauren · Liminal

Link: buridansridge.com/p/in-plain-sight

GPT-5: It Just Does Stuff: Putting the AI in Charge OK

Ethan Mollick · One Useful Thing

Link: oneusefulthing.org/p/gpt-5-it-just-does-stuff

Using AI Right Now: A Quick Guide: Which AIs to use, and how to use them OK

Ethan Mollick · One Useful Thing
Link: oneusefulthing.org/p/using-ai-right-now-a-quick-guide
Also in #6.

Interesting reads #6

AI and the automation of work OK
Benedict Evans · ben-evans.com
Link: ben-evans.com/benedictevans/2023/7/2/working-with-ai

Life in India is a series of bilateral negotiations: Finding the new equilibrium for the next superpower OK
Rohit Krishnan · Strange Loop Canon
Link: strangeloopcanon.com/p/life-in-india-is-a-series-of-bilateral

Why Bats Shouldn't Exist: The Limits of Knowledge, the Pitfalls of Prediction, and the Triumph of the Possible Over the Probable OK
Maria Popova · The Marginalian
Link: themarginalian.org/2025/07/11/bats/

The Psychology Of Trends: Why We Love, Adopt, and Leave Them BROKEN
Lottie Bisou · The Art Director
Link (Wayback Machine archive): web.archive.org (archived 2025-11-07): meettheartdirector.substack.com/p/the-psychology-of-trends-…
Original link (broken): meettheartdirector.substack.com/p/the-psychology-of-trends-why-we-love
Original link no longer works; the archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

Using AI Right Now: A Quick Guide: Which AIs to use, and how to use them OK
Ethan Mollick · One Useful Thing
Link: oneusefulthing.org/p/using-ai-right-now-a-quick-guide
Also in #5.

Interesting reads #7

Why the super rich are inevitable OK
Alvin Chang · The Pudding
Link: pudding.cool/2022/12/yard-sale/

Six Types of Wealth OK
Jack Raines · Young Money
Link: youngmoney.co/p/six-types-wealth

The untold story of Where is My Train's 100M users OK
Dharmesh Ba · The Indian Notes
Link: newsletter.theindianotes.com/p/the-untold-story-of-where-is-my-trains
Also in #21.

Is Artificial Intelligence Impossible? Aristotle & Aquinas on AI OK
Jeremy J. Mallett · The Collector
Link: thecollector.com/artificial-intelligence-impossible-aristotle-aquinas/

The Hidden Costs of Happiness OK
Mark Manson · markmanson.net
Link: markmanson.net/hidden-costs-of-happiness

Interesting reads #8

Toward a Shallower Future OK

Noah Smith · Noahpinion

Link: noahpinion.blog/p/toward-a-shallower-future-2ab

The Inside of the Outside is the Inside BROKEN

Allessandra Inzinna · NK.exe

No working link found.

Original link (broken): nkexe.substack.com/p/the-inside-of-the-outside-is-the

Post removed by its author; no archived copy or republication found.

How Chinese Porcelain Became a Symbol of Power and Taste OK

Mike Cohen · The Collector

Link: thecollector.com/chinese-porcelain-symbol-of-power/

The Intellectual Obesity Crisis OK

Gurwinder · The Prism

Link: gurwinder.blog/p/the-intellectual-obesity-crisis

The rewards of ruin OK

Luke Kemp · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/the-great-myth-of-empire-collapse

Interesting reads #9

Why Procrastinators Procrastinate OK

Tim Urban · Wait But Why

Link: waitbutwhy.com/2013/10/why-procrastinators-procrastinate.html

The Problem With Too Much Logic OK

Abhishek Chakraborty · The Sunday Wisdom

Link: coffeeandjunk.substack.com/p/eccentricity

Fuel, Medicine, Pleasure OK

Krista Diamond · Longreads

Link: longreads.com/2024/05/30/body-image-krista-diamond/

The Lesson to Unlearn OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/lesson.html

The real reason humans are the dominant species OK

Justin Rowlatt & Laurence Knight · BBC News

Link: bbc.com/news/science-environment-56544239

Interesting reads #10

How to be bored again (what your brain does when you do nothing) OK

Dr. Dominic Ng · Brain Health, Decoded

Link: brainhealthdecoded.com/p/the-radical-case-for-being-bored

Is it time to change how we buy travel souvenirs? OK

Tarang Mohnot · BBC News

Link: bbc.com/travel/article/20250217-is-it-time-to-change-how-we-buy-travel-souven…

What If I'm Not Technical Enough for AI? PAID

Nate · Nate's Substack

Official link (paid): natesnewsletter.substack.com/p/what-if-im-not-technical-enough-for

The official link needs a subscription; no free copy exists.

The Goldilocks Theory of Being Rich OK

Ben Casnocha · casnocha.com

Link: casnocha.com/pros-and-cons-of-wealth-the-goldilocks-theory

Thinking Different is Never Popular (at First) OK

Louis Anslow · Pessimists' Archive

Link: newsletter.pessimistsarchive.org/p/thinking-different-is-never-popular

Interesting reads #11

Doomprompting Is the New Doomscrolling. OK

Anu Atluru · Working Theorys

Link: workingtheorys.com/p/doomprompting

How to slow down time (the neuroscience of time perception) OK

Yana Yuhai · Mindbox

Link: contemplationstation.substack.com/p/how-to-expand-time-the-neuroscience

The Bliss of a Quieter Ego PAID

Arthur C. Brooks · The Atlantic

Official link (paid): theatlantic.com/ideas/archive/2025/05/quiet-ego-happiness-virtue/682718/

Free archived copy: web.archive.org (archived 2026-05-31): theatlantic.com/ideas/archive/2025/05/quiet-ego-happiness-v…

The official link needs a subscription; the free archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

The Origins of Wokeness OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/woke.html

AI isn't replacing radiologists OK

Deena Mousa · Works in Progress

Link: worksinprogress.news/p/why-ai-isnt-replacing-radiologists

Interesting reads #12

An Existential Guide to: Making Friends OK

The Shadowed Archive · The Shadowed Archive

Link: theshadowedarchive.substack.com/p/an-existential-guide-to-making-friends

AI is polytheistic, not monotheistic OK

Balaji Srinivasan · balajis.com

Link: balajis.com/p/ai-is-polytheistic-not-monotheistic

You're overspending because you lack values PAID

Sherry Ning · sherryning.com

Official link (paid): sherryning.com/p/youre-overspending-because-you-lack-values

Free archived copy: web.archive.org (archived 2025-09-19): sherryning.com/p/youre-overspending-because-you-lack-values

The official link needs a subscription; the free archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

The dawn of the post-literate society OK

James Marriott · Cultural Capital

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-173338158

Kabul in my heart OK

Maryam Mahjoba · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/one-womans-eye-witness-account-of-life-under-taliban-rule

Interesting reads #13

How to understand things OK

Nabeel S. Qureshi · nabeelqu.substack.com

Link: nabeelqu.substack.com/p/understanding

The self is the platform OK

Anu Atluru · Working Theorys

Link: workingtheorys.com/p/the-self

How I read OK

Henrik Karlsson · Escaping Flatland

Link: henrikkarlsson.xyz/p/how-i-read

Minds grow where walls meet OK

Lina · The Science of Being

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-176057486

Should we edit nature? OK

David Farrier · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/should-we-intervene-in-evolution-the-ethics-of-editing-nature

Interesting reads #14

How to be disgustingly educated (pt.1 & 2) OK

Amira · Thee Book Club

Link: theebookclubx.substack.com/p/how-to-be-disgustingly-educated

Part 2: substack.com/home/post/p-176648253

Why warm countries are poorer OK

Tomas Pueyo · Uncharted Territories

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-174486304

The TikTok-isation of writing OK

Tamara · Museguided

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-176856479

An opinionated guide to using AI right now OK

Ethan Mollick · One Useful Thing

Link: oneusefulthing.org/p/an-opinionated-guide-to-using-ai

The 18 mistakes that kill startups OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/startupmistakes.html

Interesting reads #15

China’s 2040 vision: Economic spillover as geopolitical strategy OK

The International Strategist · The International Strategist

Link: theintlstrat.substack.com/p/chinas-2040-vision-economic-spillover

Luck, by design OK

Harnidh Kaur · HK's newsletter

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-176536560

What sleep is OK

Vladyslav Vyazovskiy · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/two-billion-humans-are-doing-something-bizarre-right-now-sleep…

Being honest with yourself is hard OK

Scott H. Young · Scott H Young
Link: scotthyoung.com/blog/2015/06/04/self-honesty/

After work: If AI takes all our jobs, what's next for humanity? OK

Thom Waite · Dazed
Link: dazeddigital.com/life-culture/article/65480/1/future-beyond-work-ai-robot-tak…

Interesting reads #16

The Jessica Simulation: Love and loss in the age of AI OK

Jason Fagone · San Francisco Chronicle
Link: sfchronicle.com/projects/2021/jessica-simulation-artificial-intelligence/

How to end your extremely online era OK

Tommy Dixon · tommydixon.ca
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-176949267

Who are you when you're not pleasing anyone? OK

Lina · The Science of Being
Link: softperception.substack.com/p/who-are-you-when-youre-not-pleasing

Trump and Xi are about to sign a trade deal that proves America lost the trade war OK

The International Strategist · The International Strategist
Link: theintlstrat.substack.com/p/trump-and-xi-are-about-to-sign-a

Why does it feel like everyone has more money than you? OK

Jen Doll · Harper's Bazaar
Link: harpersbazaar.com/culture/features/a26091060/money-millennials-parents-career…

Interesting reads #17

How to Trick Your Brain into Doing Difficult Things OK

Dr. Dominic Ng · Brain Health, Decoded
Link: brainhealthdecoded.com/p/how-to-trick-your-brain-into-doing

How to articulate yourself intelligently OK

Dan Koe · Future/Proof
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-179471951

The deepest South OK

Ana Lucia Araujo · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/way-down-south-slavery-far-beyond-the-united-states

Haters OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com
Link: paulgraham.com/fh.html

The hunger to be everything. OK

Amber · odetoapoet
Link: odetoapoet.substack.com/p/the-hunger-to-be-everything

Interesting reads #18

Mask on/mask off OK

Gilly Kahn · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/the-hidden-costs-of-masking-for-women-with-adhd-and-autism

The Conscious And Subconscious Mind: Everything You Need To Know OK

Ixcarus · The Forbidden Files
Link: ixcarus.substack.com/p/the-conscious-and-subconscious-mind

Are Attention Spans Actually Shrinking? (Part 1&2) OK
Jon Stahl · How not to be TV writer
Link: hownot.substack.com/p/are-attention-spans-actually-shrinking

The disappearance of awe (and what it does to our brain) OK
Yana Yuhai · Mindbox
Link: contemplationstation.substack.com/p/the-disappearance-of-awe-and-how

Why we didn't get a malaria vaccine sooner OK
Saloni Dattani & Rachel Glennerster & Siddhartha Haria · Works in Progress
Link: worksinprogress.co/issue/why-we-didnt-get-a-malaria-vaccine-sooner/

Interesting reads #19

Embarrassment Has Good Bones OK
Katie Bird · Marrow
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-94293933

Finding Peter Putnam OK
Amanda Gefter · Nautilus
Link: nautil.us/finding-peter-putnam-1218035/
Nautilus is metered: free for occasional readers.

Live a Disciplined Life, Spontaneously OK
Naval's Archive · Naval's Archive
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-170578362

Life On a Blacklist OK
Perry Link · China Books Review
Link: chinabooksreview.com/2025/04/03/life-on-blacklist/

How to live with the discomfort of learning (instead of running from it) OK
Ayushi Thakkar · Milk and cookies
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-173528842

Interesting reads #20

Everyone is numbing out OK
Catherine Shannon · catherineshannon.substack.com
Link: catherineshannon.substack.com/p/everyone-is-numbing-out

The Race between Waymo, Cybercab, and Uber OK
Tomas Pueyo · Uncharted Territories
Link: unchartedterritories.tomaspueyo.com/p/the-race-between-waymo-cybercab-and

How to fix your entire life in 1 day OK
Dan Koe · Future/Proof
Link: letters.thedankoe.com/p/how-to-fix-your-entire-life-in-1

The two stages of mastery for those with many passions OK
Joel Uili · The Career Archetypes by Joel Uili
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-170173404

The poetic beauty of nature OK
James Lucas · Beauty is truth

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-181189390

Interesting reads #21

The World in Which We Live OK

Nassim Nicholas Taleb · nntaleb.substack.com

Link: nntaleb.substack.com/p/the-world-in-which-we-live

The Only Indian City Where Life Has Improved OK

Manu Joseph · manujoseph.substack.com

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-182389492

The Performative Epidemic: Why Everything Feels Fake Now OK

Ixcarus · The Forbidden Files

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-181021890

The Ultimate Guide To Power OK

Cultural Chronicler · The Itihāsa Imprint

Link: cultchron.substack.com/p/the-indian-guide-to-realism

The untold story of Where is My Train's 100M users OK

Dharmesh Ba · The Indian Notes

Link: newsletter.theindianotes.com/p/the-untold-story-of-where-is-my-trains

Also in #7.

Interesting reads #22

India In Charts - The House View OK

Rahul Sanghi · Tigerfeathers

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-181308548

Intelligence Is Getting What You Want Out of Life OK

Conquer · conquer1.substack.com

Link: conquer1.substack.com/p/intelligence-is-getting-what-you

Why You Are Probably An NPC OK

Gurwinder · The Prism

Link: gurwinder.blog/p/why-you-are-probably-an-npc

Why India doesn't export Milk? OK

Abhed Manocha · Manocha Opinion

Link: manochaopinion.substack.com/p/why-india-doesnt-export-milk

How to do everything you want in your twenties OK

Jay · JW Meditations

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-159451458

Interesting reads #23

The Bus Ticket Theory of Genius OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/genius.html

The Art of (Attention) War OK

Matt Klein and Nick Susi · Zine

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-182335102

How to be more agentic OK

Cate Hall · Useful Fictions
Link: usefulfictions.substack.com/p/how-to-be-more-agentic

How to live an intellectually rich life OK
Utsav Mamoria · Tumse Na Ho Paayega
Link: utsavmamoria.substack.com/p/how-to-live-an-intellectually-rich

Everything is Computer OK
Ryan McEntush · a16z news
Link: a16z.news/p/everything-is-computer

Unrot your brain OK
Kylee · plum pits
Link: plumpits.substack.com/p/unrot-your-brain

Full guide: how to unlock extreme focus on command OK
Dan Koe · X · X post
Link: x.com/thedankoe/status/2012956603297964167

A $380B Opportunity for Indian Brands OK
Fatema Raja · Layer by layer
Link: fatemaraja.substack.com/p/a-380b-opportunity-for-indian-brands

The Smartest People I Know Are Obsessed With a Skill Many Were Told Is Useless OK
Eva Keiffenheim · Lifelong Learning Club
Link: evakeiffenheim.substack.com/p/the-smartest-people-i-know-are-obsessed

Horn "OK" Please? OK
Atharva Chaporkar · atharvajc.substack.com
Link: atharvajc.substack.com/p/horn-ok-please

Interesting reads #24

Train Your Brain to Handle Hard Things Without Wanting to Quit OK
Jim Kwik · Kwik Brain
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-182270838

Manufacturing is a war now OK
Noah Smith · Noahpinion
Link: noahpinion.blog/p/manufacturing-is-a-war-now

How to become successful & make friends as an introvert OK
Chase Harris · X · X post
Link: x.com/chaseharris98/status/2014026595183329306

The puzzle of Pakistan's poverty OK
Rohit Shinde · The Indic Prism
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-183381837

Incandescent anger OK
Paul Katsafanasi · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/what-explains-the-perpetual-need-for-political-enemies

The lies I used to tell myself OK
Cate Hall · Useful Fictions
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-185470552

Why are India's youth still flocking to civil service exams? OK
Sahaj Sankaran · Incredible (-y Complicated) India

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-185995915

Why Indians Might Be The Next Global Scapegoats OK

Sahil Vaidya · Learning Machine

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-182679531

The pain of becoming yourself BROKEN

Alastair · YouTube · video

Link (official alternative): youtube.com/watch?v=yVN7qBv3kf8

Original link (broken): youtube.com/watch?v=QYAnJ_QyCQg

Original video was removed; this is the same creator's re-upload.

You Were The Smart Kid... So What Went Wrong? OK

Mark Manson · YouTube · video

Link: youtube.com/watch?v=ICTgC1RDhng

How to Change Your Life OK

Alex Hormozi · YouTube · video

Link: youtube.com/watch?v=MZPVPCIeUpg

The 5-hour rule: How to turn a wasted day into a successful one OK

Jonny Thomson · Big Think

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-169567989

You've (Likely) Been Playing The Game of Life Wrong OK

Veritasium · YouTube · video

Link: youtu.be/HBluLfX2F_k

The most important lesson from 83,000 brain scans OK

TEDx Talks · YouTube · video

Link: youtube.com/watch?v=esPRsT-Imw8

Why Do We Dream? OK

Vsauce · YouTube · video

Link: youtube.com/watch?v=7GGzc3x9WJU

Interesting reads #25

Stigmergy: the most important concept you've never heard of OK

Francis Heylighen · The Self-Organizing Universe - Francis Heylighen

Link: francisheylighen.substack.com/p/stigmergy-the-most-important-concept

How to think like a strategic genius (5D thinking) OK

Dan Koe · X · X post

Link: x.com/thedankoe/status/2016200242690195509

The Psychology of Consumerism: How Capitalism Needs You Miserable OK

Ixcarus · The Forbidden Files

Link: ixcarus.substack.com/p/the-psychology-of-consumerism-how

Lessons I learnt from burning out OK

Primordial intelligence · X · X post

Link: x.com/primal_brainer/status/2018967906999320862

What India's Bookstores Reveal OK

Sahil Vaidya · Learning Machine

Link: sahilist.substack.com/p/what-indias-bookstores-reveal

Why philosophers hate that 'equity' meme OK

Joseph Heath · In Due Course
Link: josephheath.substack.com/p/why-philosophers-hate-that-equity

How to become dangerously self-educated OK
Craig Perry · Profound Ideas
Link: ideas.profoundideas.com/p/how-to-become-dangerously-self-educated

Clearing Your Allostatic Load Makes Laziness Impossible OK
Rian Doris · X · X post
Link: x.com/RianSweetDoris/status/2019833629233324539

The Other Half of "Artists Ship" OK
Paul Graham · paulgraham.com
Link: paulgraham.com/artistsship.html

Cicada 3301: An Internet Mystery OK
LEMMiNO · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/I2O7bISSzpI

Undercover in North Korea | Then and Now with Lisa Ling OK
National Geographic · YouTube · video
Link: youtube.com/watch?v=eLCdsXRiouE

Marcus Aurelius: The Man Who Solved the Universe OK
Horses · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/tv6W0Nv5ev0

The Strange Freedom Of Knowing Nothing OK
Gawx Art · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/aXntSsF5-uc

Why the U.S. President Is Almost Impossible to Kill OK
Fern · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/-1DvXSsWKLI

Interesting reads #26

You are no longer the smartest type of thing on Earth PAID
Noah Smith · Noahpinion
Official link (paid): noahpinion.blog/p/you-are-no-longer-the-smartest-type
The official link needs a subscription; no free copy exists.

How selfish are we? OK
Jonathan R Goodman · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/we-cooperate-to-survive-but-if-no-ones-looking-we-compete

A theory of the Post-Human Internet and the next form of commerce OK
Paul Finney · X · X post
Link: x.com/paulfinneyx/status/2020091636064321816

Of course they’re putting ads in AI OK
Bryan Kim · a16z news
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-187207858

You are the stories you tell yourself OK
Janelle · one cup of tea
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-181209814

What Did Depression Look Like Before 'Antidepressants'? OK

Dr. Roger McFillin · Radically Genuine
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-184539596

You can build a $10B+ company fully remotely OK
Alex Bouaziz · X · X post
Link: x.com/Bouazizalex/status/2020159203382550530

The System That Punishes Beautiful Design OK
Design Theory · YouTube · video
Link: youtube.com/watch?v=4haFPDNSuPY

The Highest Levels of Thinking | Why Society is Stuck at the bottom OK
Aperture · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/HraPf_MCcps

How Were the Pyramids Actually Built? OK
Fern · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/vJucA4FOTSI

Emergent Complexity OK
Emergent Garden · YouTube · video
Link: youtube.com/watch?v=0HqUYpGQIfs

That's AI OK
@bymaximise · X · video
Link: x.com/bymaximise/status/2019822220407894360

Tsodilo Hills, Botswana | Africa's Cultural Landmarks OK
the Met · YouTube · video
Link: youtube.com/watch?v=H5h0q1PE2Qk&t=200s

Why Finland And Denmark Are Happier Than The U.S. OK
CNBC Make It · YouTube · video
Link: youtu.be/6Pm0Mn0-jYU

Interesting reads #27

I'm Sorry to Burst Your Bubble: You Are Being Fooled About AI, and You Will Soon Feel Really Stupid OK
David William Silva · davidwsilva.substack.com
Link: davidwsilva.substack.com/p/im-sorry-to-burst-your-bubble-you

Top Performers are Pathologically Ambitious OK
Matt Beard · That Vast Variety
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-187790585

It's Official: The World Order Has Broken Down OK
Ray Dalio · X · X post
Link: x.com/RayDalio/status/2022788750388998543

How Social Media Shortens Your Life OK
Gurwinder · The Prism
Link: gurwinder.blog/p/how-social-media-shortens-your-life

The quiet thrill of not being for everyone OK
Stepfanie Tyler · BAD GIRL MEDIA
Link: badgirlmedia.com/p/the-quiet-thrill-of-not-being-for

Interesting reads #28

My six stages of learning to be a socially normal person OK

Sasha Chapin · Sasha's newsletter

Link: sashachapin.substack.com/p/my-six-stages-of-learning-to-be-a

How to prepare for the next decade OK

Scott Barker · The Wake Up Call

Link: thewakeupcallnewsletter.substack.com/p/how-to-prepare-for-the-next-decade

Confessions of a Claudaholic! OK

Dharmesh Ba · Messy Logic

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-188698011

The Art of Discernment OK

Words of Taoism · Life Wisdom - Words of Taoism

Link: taoismteachings.substack.com/p/the-art-of-discernment

Why You Can't Just Do Things OK

Octopusyarn · octopusyarn.com

Link: octopusyarn.substack.com/p/why-you-cant-just-do-things

Interesting reads #29

Game Theory Will Change Your Life: The Invisible Rules Running Every Interaction OK

Ixcarus · The Forbidden Files

Link: ixcarus.substack.com/p/game-theory-will-change-your-life

How to engineer luck OK

George Mack · High Agency

Link: essays.highagency.com/p/how-could-you-double-your-luck-in

About Iran, from an Iranian Woman OK

Lilsmichelle · lilsmichelle.substack.com

Link: lilsmichelle.substack.com/p/about-iran-from-an-iranian-woman

The Death of Spotify: Why Streaming is Minutes Away From Being Obsolete OK

Joel Gouveia · The Artist Economy

Link: joelgouveia.substack.com/p/the-death-of-spotify-why-streaming

The Tyranny Of Time OK

Joe Zadeh · Noema

Link: noemamag.com/the-tyranny-of-time/

Interesting reads #30

White Collar Goes Blue PAID

Anu Atluru · Working Theorys

Official link (paid): workingtheorys.com/p/white-collar

Free archived copy: web.archive.org (archived 2026-03-06): workingtheorys.com/p/white-collar

The official link needs a subscription; the free archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

You're probably addicted to thinking OK

Alex Olshonsky · Deep Fix

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-189061072

Why ATMs didn't kill bank teller jobs, but the iPhone did OK

David Oks · davidoks.blog

Link: davidoks.blog/p/why-the-atm-didnt-kill-bank-teller

Why Are Some People Just So Magnetic? OK

Joanna Kaze · Besserschmecker

Link: besserschmecker.substack.com/p/why-are-some-people-just-so-magnetic

Good conversations have lots of doorknobs OK

Adam Mastroianni · Experimental History

Link: experimental-history.com/p/good-conversations-have-lots-of-doorknobs

Interesting reads #32

Discipline Comes from Having No Choice OK

Conquer · Conquer

Link: conquer1.substack.com/p/having-no-choice-makes-you-disciplined

Rick Rubin Is the Future of Work OK

Tom White · White noise

Link: whitenoise.email/p/rick-rubin-is-the-future-of-work

Orthodox Privilege OK

Paul Graham · paulgraham.com

Link: paulgraham.com/orth.html

Everything that turned out well in my life followed the same design process OK

Henrik Karlsson · Escaping Flatland

Link: henrikkarlsson.xyz/p/unfolding

How To Start Having Original Thoughts OK

Feifei · Feifei's Substack

Link: feifeiwrites.substack.com/p/how-to-start-having-original-thoughts

Interesting reads #33

3 philosophical debates from the 20th century that neuroscience is reshaping OK

Rachel Barr · Big Think

Link: bigthink.com/thinking/3-philosophical-questions-of-the-20th-century-that-neur…

Why the ancient Brahmins of Kerala converted to Christianity OK

Manu Joseph · manujoseph.substack.com

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-190840154

The Art of Being Unreachable OK

Alexis Mcelroy · The Muse & The Melody

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-185360809

The invention of the soul OK

Nicholas Humphrey · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/you-know-what-consciousness-is-you-live-in-soul-land

The epidemic of constant communication OK

Amanda Brown · Good riddance

Link: amandagoodriddance.substack.com/p/the-epidemic-of-constant-communication

Interesting reads #34

No One Will Remember Your Name PAID

Kaguura Gichuru · The Write Path

Official link (paid): kaguura.substack.com/p/no-one-will-remember-your-name
Free archived copy: web.archive.org (archived 2026-04-29): kaguura.substack.com/p/no-one-will-remember-your-name
The official link needs a subscription; the free archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

Intellectuals are F*cking Idiots OK
Mark Manson · markmanson.substack.com
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-194183403

Neuroplasticity: Rewiring Your Brain To Do Hard Things OK
Ixcarus · The Forbidden Files
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-183277826

People who demand nothing of you (or, notes on charismatic people) OK
Carmen · Altered
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-147221329

The Aesthetics Of Excess OK
Girish Avadhany and Aditya Chauhan · Thinking Incentives
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-193683678

Interesting reads #35

Can ecosystems malfunction? OK
John Drake · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/why-we-need-to-think-again-about-ecosystem-failure

Why You Always Want What You Can't Have OK
Ixcarus · The Forbidden Files
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-199806748

Sometimes the reason you can’t find people you resonate with is because you misread the ones you meet OK
Henrik Karlsson · Escaping Flatland
Link: henrikkarlsson.xyz/p/friends-missed

Maybe you’re not Actually Trying OK
Cate Hall · Useful Fictions
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-164087434

Nobody Is Coming to Make Your Life Interesting OK
Hayes Carrera · Collector's Vault
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-190119826

Interesting reads #36

Kerala, Breasts, and the Tax that Wasn’t OK
Manu S Pillai · Manu's Substack
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-193041159

Animal, Vegetable, Lamb OK
Thom Sliwowski · The Public Domain Review
Link: publicdomainreview.org/essay/animal-vegetable-lamb/

Watch men OK
Aled Maclean-Jones · Works in Progress
Link: worksinprogress.co/issue/watch-men/

Being small OK

Tom Wooldridge · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/the-power-imbalance-between-parent-and-child-leaves-a-trace

Taste Is Eating Silicon Valley OK
Anu Atluru · Working Theorys
Link: workingtheorys.com/p/taste-is-eating-silicon-valley

Interesting reads #37

How to become dangerously articulate OK
Craig Perry · Profound Ideas
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-180115552

Why China got rich and India didn't OK
David Oks · davidoks.blog
Link: davidoks.blog/p/why-china-got-rich-and-india-didnt

Once you understand neuroplasticity your life will never be the same again OK
Tim Denning · Modern Freedom
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-194370773

The Emperor's New Clothes OK
Simran Agarwal · The Public Domain Review
Link: publicdomainreview.org/essay/the-emperors-new-clothes/

You Would Never Say That To A Friend. So Why Do You Say It To Yourself? OK
Feifei · Feifei's Substack
Link: feifeiwrites.substack.com/p/you-would-never-say-that-to-a-friend

Interesting reads #38

A frontier without an ecosystem is not stable OK
Satya Nadella · X · X post
Link: x.com/satyanadella/status/2066182223213293753

Why some conversations rearrange your brain OK
Maja · Velvet Noise
Link: velvetnoise.substack.com/p/why-some-conversations-rearrange

Most high-income skills will be irrelevant in 10 years (learn these 4 skills instead) OK
Hussain Ibarra · The Profitable Micro Business
Link: hussainibarra.substack.com/p/most-high-income-skills-will-be-irrelevant

Why Japanese companies do so many different things OK
David Oks · davidoks.blog
Link: davidoks.blog/p/why-japanese-companies-do-so-many

How to be good at research OK
Vivek · X · X post
Link: x.com/itsreallyvivek/status/2064686372737454155

Principles OK
Nabeel S. Qureshi · nabeelqu.substack.com
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-154681274

Interesting reads #39

How Empathy Makes Us Cruel and Irrational OK

Gurwinder · The Prism
Link: gurwinder.blog/p/how-empathy-makes-us-cruel-and-crazy

Treasure Your Attention OK
Jon Haidt · After Babel
Link: afterbabel.com/p/haidt-nyu-commencement-address

You Have To Be Human OK
Freya India · After Babel
Link: afterbabel.com/p/you-have-to-be-human

The power of knowing what you like OK
Sydney Rheeder · for the record
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-177816624

The Mathematical Reason Most People Never "Make It" OK
Kaguura Gichuru · The Write Path
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-184527011

Interesting reads #40

How To Become a Mathematical Genius OK
Sinéad O'Sullivan · But This Time It's Different
Link: butthistime.com/p/how-to-become-a-mathematical-genius

Human 3.0 – A Map To Reach The Top 1% OK
Dan Koe · X · X post
Link: x.com/thedankoe/status/2023779299367809063

The anguish of choice OK
Skye C Cleary · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/re-reading-sartres-lecture-existentialism-is-a-humanism

Why people fail at learning languages OK
Colin Gorrie · Dead Language Society
Link: deadlanguagesociety.com/p/why-people-fail-at-learning-languages

How to tell a good story OK
Dylan · Uncynical
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-177260370

Interesting reads #41

Make Something Heavy. OK
Anu Atluru · Working Theorys
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-158538641

Riding the Leopard PAID
Packy McCormick · Not Boring
Official link (paid): notboring.co/p/riding-the-leopard
The official link needs a subscription; no free copy exists.

Stop screeching about immigration, and get smart about it OK
Noah Smith · Noahpinion
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-204705929

"Worthless Idiot, Donkey Head" OK
Arnoud S. Q. Visser · The Public Domain Review

Link: publicdomainreview.org/essay/parodies-of-pedantry/

How to enter side doors OK

Maja · Velvet Noise
Link: velvetnoise.substack.com/p/how-to-enter-side-doors

Interesting reads #42

A Framework for Frontier AI and the Dawning of a New Age OK

Demis Hassabis · X · X post
Link: x.com/demishassabis/status/2076957440109625718

38 ways to create more than you consume, while you consume OK

Tuğba Avci · As slow as possible
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-189349567

Whose path are you on? OK

Erifili Gounari · crystal clear
Link: erifili.substack.com/p/whose-path-are-you-on

Words, words, words OK

Martin Puchner · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/literature-fans-should-welcome-ai-as-a-fellow-wordsmith

Face it: you're a crazy person OK

Adam Mastroianni · Experimental History
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-166676460

Interesting reads #43

Fear and Fragility OK

Tamara Sanderson · The Public Domain Review
Link: publicdomainreview.org/essay/fear-and-fragility-the-glass-delusion-and-its-hi…

The Weird Guilt of Having a Better Life Than Your Parents. OK

Feifei · Feifei's substack
Link: feifeiwrites.substack.com/p/the-weird-guilt-of-having-a-better

How Kepler Invented Science Fiction and Defended His Mother in a Witchcraft Trial While Revolutionizing Our Understanding of the Universe OK

Maria Popova · The Marginalian
Link: themarginalian.org/2019/12/26/katharina-kepler-witchcraft-dream/

Attention is all we have OK

David Bessis · davidbessis.substack.com
Link: davidbessis.substack.com/p/attention-is-all-we-have

The real reason some people are instantly likable OK

Francesca Tighinean · Big Think
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-191413331

Interesting reads #44

Why Am I Left-Handed? OK

Natalie Wolchover · Quanta Magazine
Link: quantamagazine.org/why-am-i-left-handed-20260713/

Engineering the disposable diaper OK

Virginia Postrel · Works in Progress
Link: worksinprogress.co/issue/engineering-the-disposable-diaper/

Holes in the web OK
Deepak Varuvel Dennison · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/generative-ai-has-access-to-a-small-slice-of-human-knowledge

Cybernetic Attention OK
D. Graham Burnett · The Public Domain Review
Link: publicdomainreview.org/essay/cybernetic-attention/

Why Nature Allowed a Trillionaire to Exist PAID
Kaguura Gichuru · The Write Path
Official link (paid): kaguura.substack.com/p/why-nature-allowed-a-trillionaire
The official link needs a subscription; no free copy exists.

Interesting reads #45

What Makes Humans Stupid OK
David C. Krakauer · Nautilus
Link: nautil.us/what-makes-humans-stupid-1282459
Nautilus is metered: free for occasional readers.

Text is king OK
Adam Mastroianni · Experimental History
Link: experimental-history.com/p/text-is-king

Speaking for the Dead OK
Sam Roberts · Longreads
Link: longreads.com/2026/08/11/obituaries-new-york-times-sam-roberts/

Genuine curiosity will always beat performative intellectualism BROKEN
Hasif Core · Letters from Hasif
Link (Wayback Machine archive): web.archive.org (archived 2026-09-13): hasifcore.substack.com/p/genuine-curiosity-will-always-beat
Original link (broken): substack.com/home/post/p-208646498
Original link no longer works; the archived copy was checked and shows the full text.

Towards an AI for Africa OK
Fainos Mangena · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/an-ai-for-africa-would-be-built-on-hunhu-ubuntu-ethics

Interesting reads #46

Why AI Needs A Sense Of Smell OK
Philip Maughan · Noema
Link: noemamag.com/why-ai-needs-a-sense-of-smell/

Make Nothing that Isn’t Beautiful OK
John Michael Colón · The Point
Link: thepointmag.com/examined-life/make-nothing-that-isnt-beautiful/

Defending Our Consciousness Against the Algorithms OK
Michael Pollan · Nautilus
Link: nautil.us/defending-our-consciousness-against-the-algorithms-1279260
Nautilus is metered: free for occasional readers.

No Country Ever Got Rich From Tourism OK

Marko Jukic · Palladium
Link: palladiummag.com/2025/07/18/no-country-ever-got-rich-from-tourism/

Eight Patterns I Keep Seeing in Miserable People OK
Singh Bhai · TheOpenBook
Link: theopenbook.substack.com/p/eight-patterns-i-keep-seeing-in-miserable

Game theory explains why smart people don’t win. Being smart and working harder doesn’t fix money problems. OK
Tim Denning · Modern Freedom
Link: timdenning.substack.com/p/game-theory-explains-why-smart-people

Interesting reads #47

Why are rivers so mathematical? OK
Natalie Wolchover · Quanta Magazine
Link: quantamagazine.org/why-are-rivers-so-mathematical-20260810/

Waking up science’s sleeping beauties OK
Ulkar Aghayeva · Works in Progress
Link: worksinprogress.co/issue/waking-up-sciences-sleeping-beauties/

Modern Sisyphus: The absurdity of the corporate world OK
Unwana Johnson · New York Journal of Philosophy
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-210932582

Machines of loving grace OK
Dario Amodei · darioamodei.com
Link: darioamodei.com/essay/machines-of-loving-grace

How To Force Your Brain To Crave Doing Hard Things OK
Conquer · conquer1.substack.com
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-198804893

Interesting reads #48

What Becomes Valuable When Intelligence Is Cheap? OK
Houda Nait El Barj · Human Flourishing with AI
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-193693850

A History of Money, Banking and Economics OK
Rebellio · rebellio.substack.com
Link: rebellio.substack.com/p/a-history-of-money-banking-and-economics

Everyday Technology Is Becoming a Black Box. Is There a Cost? OK
Frank C. Keil · The MIT Press Reader
Link: thereader.mitpress.mit.edu/everyday-technology-is-becoming-a-black-box-is-the…

Excellence is a polymath's game OK
Alexander · Alexander Romance
Link: substack.com/home/post/p-203583422

More nothing now OK
Justin Neuman · Aeon
Link: aeon.co/essays/play-is-doing-its-work-even-if-were-not-keeping-score

Interesting reads #49

Whose AI will rule the world? OK

Jacob Dreyer · Noema

Link: noemamag.com/whose-ai-will-rule-the-world/

The thinking style that makes people vulnerable to extremism OK

Leor Zmigrod · Psyche

Link: psyche.co/ideas/the-thinking-style-that-makes-people-vulnerable-to-extremism

Why we stopped making Einsteins OK

Erik Hoel · The Intrinsic Perspective

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-41591257

The Atlas of learning OK

Hana Lee Goldin · Card Catalog

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-210413986

Why are we using machines to study our inner lives? OK

Julie Sedivy · Nautilus

Link: nautil.us/why-are-we-using-machines-to-study-our-inner-lives-1282870

Nautilus is metered: free for occasional readers.

Interesting reads #50

First we shape our feedback loops; then they shape us OK

Henrik Karlsson · Escaping Flatland

Link: henrikkarlsson.xyz/p/feedback-loops

Extinction is a continuum PAID

Ariel Saramandi · Vittles

Official link (paid): vittlesmagazine.com/p/extinction-is-a-continuum

The official link needs a subscription; no free copy exists.

The virtue of being simple OK

Brandon Keim · Nautilus

Link: nautil.us/the-virtue-of-being-simple-1283320

Nautilus is metered: free for occasional readers.

How did TVs get so cheap? OK

Brian Potter · Construction Physics

Link: construction-physics.com/p/how-did-tvs-get-so-cheap

The disappearing art of maintenance OK

Alex Vuocolo · Noema

Link: noemamag.com/the-disappearing-art-of-maintenance/

Interesting reads #51

What will happen to Indian IT? OK

David Oks · Asterisk

Link: asteriskmag.com/issues/15/what-will-happen-to-indian-it

A brief history of instant coffee OK

Benjamin Stubbing & Oscar Sykes · Works in Progress

Link: worksinprogress.co/issue/a-brief-history-of-instant-coffee/

The origins of agar OK

Corrado Nai · Asimov Press

Link: asimov.press/p/agar

How to assemble science OK

Helen Pearson · Aeon

Link: aeon.co/essays/the-life-saving-scientific-knowledge-hiding-in-plain-sight

The adults don't exist OK

George Mack · High Agency

Link: substack.com/home/post/p-200825434